

## SS1

### Words of Three Syllables Stressed on the Second Syllable

#### Introduction

In English pronunciation, word stress refers to the emphasis placed on one syllable in a word. This emphasis is usually shown through a louder voice, higher pitch, and longer duration. Correct word stress is important because it affects clarity, meaning, and natural speech.

#### Three-Syllable Words

A three-syllable word is a word that contains three distinct beats or sound units when spoken. In some three-syllable words, the stress falls on the second syllable, also known as middle-syllable stress.

#### Stress on the Second Syllable

When the stress is on the second syllable, that syllable is pronounced more strongly than the first and third syllables. This stress pattern is common in certain categories of words in English.

Stress pattern representation:

weak – STRONG – weak

#### Examples of Three-Syllable Words Stressed on the Second Syllable

Word    Syllable Division    Stress Pattern

important      im-POR-tant      weak-STRONG-weak

computer      com-PU-ter      weak-STRONG-weak

remember      re-MEM-ber      weak-STRONG-weak

develop      de-VEL-op      weak-STRONG-weak

consider      con-SID-er      weak-STRONG-weak

adventure      ad-VEN-ture      weak-STRONG-weak

attention      at-TEN-tion      weak-STRONG-weak

discover      dis-COV-er      weak-STRONG-weak

#### Common Features

Three-syllable words stressed on the second syllable often include:

Verbs (e.g. remember, consider, develop)

Longer everyday vocabulary

Words with prefixes such as re, de, con, ad.

Importance of Correct Stress

Using correct stress:

Improves intelligibility

Prevents misunderstanding

Makes speech sound natural and fluent

Is essential in spoken English and examinations

Conclusion

Understanding three-syllable words stressed on the second syllable helps learners speak English more accurately and confidently. Regular listening and practice are essential for mastering this stress pattern.